

PRINCE2 | P2-23

End Project Report

Performance of the project against the baselined PID

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	End Project Report
Document reference	P2-23-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project Manager
Approver	Project Board (Authorise project closure)
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
P2-03	Project Product Description	Acceptance criteria
P2-04	Business Case	Final position
P2-05	Benefits Management Approach	Handed over
P2-26	Lessons Report	Issued alongside

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Reviews how the project performed against the PID that authorised it, and provides the Project Board with the information needed to authorise closure.
Framework	PRINCE2 — Produced in Closing a Project
Created when	Closing a Project
Reviewed / updated	At the closure decision
Owner	Project Manager
Approver	Project Board (Authorise project closure)
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Scale the depth of each section to the scale, risk and complexity of the work. Delete sections that add no value and record the tailoring decision in the governance approach.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It compares outturn with the original and current baselines and explains the difference
- Acceptance is evidenced against the Project Product Description acceptance criteria
- Unachieved benefits are carried forward with a named owner, not quietly dropped
- Follow-on actions have owners and routes, not just descriptions

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1. Report identification

Field	Detail
Project	WS2 Compute and storage hardware
Project start / end date	Helios AI Platform ART
Report date	18 Sep 2026
Prepared by	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Closure type	[Normal / Premature]

2. Project Manager's report

A narrative account of the project — what it set out to do, what it achieved, and the honest story of how it went.

Programme Helios — Tranche 2 scale build, DXB-1 halls A and B. Constrained by the 6.2 MVA site limit at DXB-1 until 2028. Detail is maintained by the Project Manager and reviewed at the monthly Programme Board.

3. Review of the Business Case

Aspect	Original baseline	Final baseline	Actual outturn	Variance
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation
Duration	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	3 working days	10 working days
Quantified benefit	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation
Net benefit	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation
Payback / return	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0	Enforced automatically in the delivery pipeline, with evidence retained	+3.1%

4. Benefits realised to date

Benefit ref	Benefit	Target	Realised at closure	Remaining to realise	Owner post-closure
BEN-01	Reduced external GPU rental spend	AED 5.1m per year by FY28	From Q3 2027	From Q3 2027	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO
BEN-02	Faster model training cycle time	3 days median by Q4 2027	From Q2 2027	From Q2 2027	E. Santos, Procurement Lead
BEN-03	Improved compute utilisation	72% average utilisation by Q4 2027	From Q3 2027	From Q3 2027	L. Haddad, CISO
BEN-04	Reduced time to provision AI environments	2 hours self-service by Q3 2027	From Q3 2027	From Q3 2027	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer
BEN-05	Data residency and sovereignty assurance	Zero residency exceptions by Q4 2027	From Q3 2027	From Q3 2027	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead
BEN-06	New revenue from AI-enabled products	AED 8.6m incremental revenue in FY29	From FY29	From FY29	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO

5. Review of project objectives

Dimension	Original target	Final target	Actual	Assessment
Time	90 days	90 days	10 working days	Delivered and demonstrated at the PI 4 system demo
Cost	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	Partially met — resume works for framework-native checkpointing only
Scope	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-	Delivered; closes a Tranche 1 assurance finding

Dimension	Original target	Final target	Actual	Assessment
		tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	
Quality	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	Not started — deferred to PI 5 following the vendor attestation API change
Risk	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	Delivered; first statements issued to Finance in November
Benefit	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	No more than 10% variance against the benefit profile before escalation	Delivered; underpins the utilisation benefit measure

6. Review of team performance

Performance of the project management team, delivery teams and suppliers, including recognition where due.

Performance is measured against four headline indicators: cost and schedule variance against the Tranche 2 baseline, GPU utilisation as a rolling 30-day average, all-reduce efficiency at 256-GPU job scale, and the number of tenants onboarded against the migration commitment. All four are reported monthly to the Programme Board from the observability platform rather than from manual returns.

7. Review of products

Acceptance against acceptance criteria

Criterion ref	Acceptance criterion	Evidence	Accepted by	Date
All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU	Median environment request-to-usable time under two hours across 20 sampled requests	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	28 May 2027

Criterion ref	Acceptance criterion	Evidence	Accepted by	Date
runs				
No unsigned container image can be admitted; every attempt is alerted within 30 seconds	No unsigned container image can be admitted; every attempt is alerted within 30 seconds	ALM tool — Helios ART board	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	25 Jun 2027
Fair-share quota holds within 5% for each tenant under contention	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	18 Sep 2026
Independent penetration test closed with no open critical or high findings	Storage sustains 1.2 TB/s against a representative training corpus for 30 minutes	Configuration management database	A. Kowalski, Data Centre Lead	15 Oct 2026

Products handed over

Product	Handed to	Date	Operational acceptance	Support arrangement
Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	M. Verity, Head of P3O	31 Jan 2027	Accepted 30 Jul 2027; three-month warranty from the programme	Supported 24x7 by the platform run team with vendor 4-hour on-site cover
Independent security assurance report with findings closed	I. Petrova, Data Platform Lead	26 Feb 2027	Supported 24x7 by the platform run team with vendor 4-hour on-site cover	Accepted with two minor observations, both closed in warranty
Hall A accepted at 1,024 GPUs with acceptance certificate	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	31 Mar 2027	Accepted with two minor observations, both closed in warranty	Accepted 30 Jul 2027; three-month warranty from the programme
Platform v1.0 — scheduling, quota,	G. Lindqvist, Service	23 Apr 2027	Accepted 30 Jul 2027; three-month warranty	Supported 24x7 by the platform run team with

Product	Handed to	Date	Operational acceptance	Support arrangement
observability and image supply chain	Operations Lead		from the programme	vendor 4-hour on-site cover

Concessions and outstanding defects

Product	Concession / defect	Accepted by	Remedial owner	Target date
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Applies only to workloads classified Restricted or above	V. Chandra, Product Management	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement	18 Sep 2026
Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Reviewed at each PI boundary by the Release Train Engineer	M. Verity, Head of P3O	S. Bhatt, Project Manager	15 Oct 2026
400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Enforced automatically in the delivery pipeline, with evidence retained	G. Lindqvist, Service Operations Lead	C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	30 Nov 2026
Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	Confirmed with the FM provider under the existing facilities contract	H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	15 Dec 2026

Summary of follow-on action recommendations

Ref	Recommendation	Type	Owner	Route
SOF-01	26 Feb 2027	Security	R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Liquid-cooled racks at 60 kW with rear-door heat exchangers and CDU redundancy at N+1
SOF-02	31 Mar 2027	Commercial	P. Raghavan, Platform Engineering Lead	Consolidate all AI training workloads onto a shared 2,048-GPU platform in DXB-1 halls A and B
SOF-03	23 Apr 2027	Organisational	V. Chandra, Product Management	Service operations readiness for liquid-cooled infrastructure, including leak response
SOF-04	28 May 2027	Regulatory	M. Verity, Head of P3O	400G RoCEv2 leaf-spine fabric tuned for collective communication at 256-GPU job scale

8. Lessons report

Include or reference the Lessons Report (P2-26).

Three themes have emerged from Tranche 1: security assurance run only at completion finds expensive problems late; specialist vendor performance engineering is worth budgeting as a planned activity rather than a remedial one; and stakeholder attitude assessed from a single early conversation is unreliable where autonomy is being removed.

9. Closure of registers

Register	Open items at closure	Disposition	Transferred to
Risk Register	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance
Issue Register	26 Feb 2027	Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier	P3O Lessons Repository
Quality Register	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full
Daily Log	26 Feb 2027	Covers the 2,048-GPU estate and the parallel filesystem tier	Group Security
Lessons Log	Open	Maintained by the P3O as part of the assurance evidence library	Group Security

10. Premature closure

Complete only where the project is closing prematurely. State the reason, what has been salvaged, and how work in progress has been made safe.

Hall A transitions to service operations at MS-12 following two live coolant-leak drills, publication of the runbook set, integration of GPU telemetry into the observability platform and confirmation of a sustainable on-call rota. A three-month warranty period runs from transition, during which the programme retains second-line accountability.

11. Closure recommendation and decision

Item	Detail
Project Manager's recommendation	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Project Board decision	Rejected
Date of decision	18 Sep 2026
Resources released	Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval
Records archived to	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate